

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying to SFU because I am drawn to work that requires thoughtful coordination, and the ability to move initiatives forward. Throughout my career, I have taken on projects that required structure, persistence, and steady leadership across multiple stakeholders.

At Memorial University, I served as Finance Director and oversaw an operational budget of approximately 800,000 dollars. Beyond managing allocations and mid-year adjustments, I helped generate new revenue strategies for a space that had experienced years of loss. The project involved financial planning, stakeholder coordination, and long-term redevelopment thinking. Today, that renovated space serves over 25,000 students and includes inclusive upgrades such as a dry bar, accessible washroom facilities, pop-up café spaces for local businesses, and designated areas for student associations to increase engagement and foot traffic. It required balancing budget realities with community needs and long-term sustainability.

At BQT, I lead all staff registration processes, working closely with HR, IT, academic departments, and the Registrar's Office. I coordinate workflow approvals, develop visual process guides for new faculty onboarding, and manage high-volume compliance requirements. A significant part of my portfolio involves overseeing criminal record documentation for Health Sciences programs. On average, I review over 300 records per week, ensuring careful assessment of each file to protect vulnerable adults and children when students enter practicum settings such as hospitals. The work requires discretion, policy interpretation, and strong risk awareness. I am accountable for ensuring that no student proceeds without proper clearance, maintaining alignment with institutional and ministry.

In addition to my operational responsibilities, I support the department's front-facing function whenever required. Our team consists of five officers and a supervisor, who primarily oversees the day-to-day frontline workflow. We collectively ensure service continuity for a team of 12 customer service representatives, particularly when managing staff absences or periods of high demand. We take turns providing oversight and coordination, balancing frontline management with our individual project portfolios. As a result, I regularly move between frontline coordination and project delivery to maintain consistent service standards.

One of the most rewarding initiatives I led at BQT was a long-standing staff job reassessment project that had remained unresolved for nearly a decade. Bringing this forward required careful review of extensive documentation, meaningful consultation with union representatives, close coordination with internal leadership, and structured communication to ensure fairness and transparency throughout the process. I established a clear framework, organized the required materials, facilitated constructive discussions across stakeholders, and sustained momentum until the matter was successfully resolved. Seeing this reach a fair and collaborative outcome was both professionally fulfilling and impactful for the team.

Alongside this, I contributed to proposal initiatives, including one that resulted in our team receiving the 2025 Outstanding Team Contribution Award. It was rewarding to see well-executed work recognized institutionally.

Beyond my formal roles, I have led large-scale cultural initiatives in partnership with municipal stakeholders, overseeing planning, budgets, volunteers, and risk to deliver inclusive and sustainable programs with accountability and impact. I look forward to contributing meaningfully at SFU.

Sincerely,
Fahmida Ahmed